

US (72%), but the trajectory is clear. India's pipeline of first-generation wealth is only getting deeper and younger.

A WIDENING BASE

The base is expanding as fast as its top tier. India currently has over 8,50,000 high-net-worth individuals (HNIs), a number expected to nearly double to 1.65 million by 2027, as per an Anarock report. Those under 30 are 15% of that. This means roughly 1,27,500 people under 30 have a net worth of \$1 million or more.

This share is projected to climb further. The under-30s are expected to account for a quarter of India's millionaires by 2030. At this pace, it may only be a matter of years before India's billionaire cohort starts to skew towards the young and self-made, a shift that is playing out faster than most would have predicted even five years ago.

BEYOND MUMBAI & TECH

The geography of Indian wealth is shifting alongside its age. For decades, the road to serious money ran through a handful of cities. Mumbai dominated the overall billionaire list while Bengaluru and Delhi drove much of the newer, self-made wealth.

While legacy wealth remains heavily concentrated in Mumbai and Delhi, the new pipeline is increasingly emerging from Bengaluru, Pune, Hyderabad, and Ahmedabad, fuelled by tech talent clusters and regional manufacturing booms.

Many of these rising wealth creators haven't yet crossed the billion-dollar mark, but are closing in fast, and they come from

THE BIG CHANGE

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UP 15% OF ALL
HNIs IN INDIA

BENGALURU,
PUNE,
HYDERABAD,
AHMEDABAD
EMERGING AS
NEW HUBS
FOR WEALTH
CREATORS IN
INDIA

THE ₹5,000-
CRORE PLUS CLUB
IS EXPANDING,
FROM JUST
61 INDIVIDUALS
IN 2012 TO
581 IN 2025

strikingly different worlds.

Few stories capture this shift better than Lalit Keshre's. His journey runs from a small farming village in Madhya Pradesh to co-founding and running Groww, now India's largest stockbroking and investment platform. Under his leadership, Groww has evolved from a mutual fund aggregator launched in 2016 into a publicly listed fintech company, scaling revenue 77x in four years and crossing market capitalisation of ₹1.36 lakh crore in 2026.

Then there's Rakesh Chopdar, whose journey began in 2008 with a small manufacturing unit in Hyderabad. His company, Azad Engineering, is now valued at over ₹15,000 crore and counts Boeing and Rolls-Royce among clients, a rare Indian success story in high-precision aerospace manufacturing, an industry with brutal entry barriers and where Indian firms have historically struggled to compete.

In real estate, Arun MN Casagrand shows how a professionalised, process-driven approach can still build outsized wealth in an industry long associated with opacity and old money. He left a marketing job at Wipro to start Casagrand in Chennai in 2004 with just five professionals, scaling operations to Coimbatore, Bengaluru, and Hyderabad, and delivering over 100 projects along the way, turning a small regional start-up into one of South India's leading residential developers.

However, not every name on this list is a founder. Akash Bhansali represents a different